

GROWING BABY

Within weeks of arriving in the womb after fertilization, the tiny ball of cells becomes an embryo. It has a beating heart and most of its organs are in place. By 11 weeks after fertilization, the growing baby,

now called a fetus, looks human. During the remaining period of pregnancy, the fetus grows rapidly and becomes stronger and more active. It finally develops into a baby and is pushed out into the world.



▲ EMBRYO AT 5 WEEKS *The bean-sized embryo's organs are developing and it has "buds" from which arms and legs grow.*



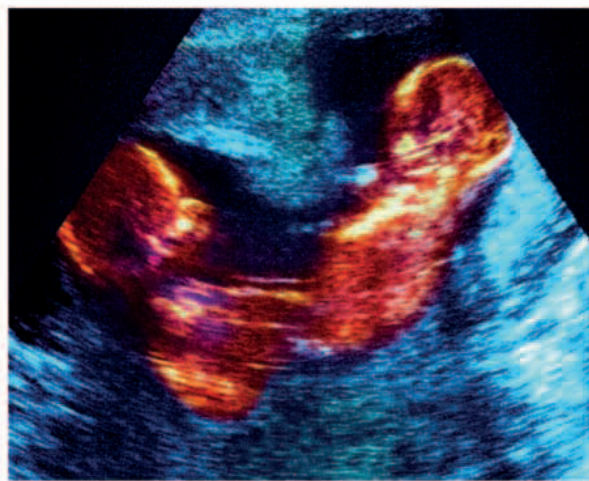
▲ FETUS AT 11 WEEKS *The lemon-sized fetus can move, and has fingers, toes, a large head, and a growing brain.*



▲ FETUS AT 26 WEEKS *The fetus has eyelashes and eyebrows, and can blink. The mother can feel it moving inside her.*

TWO OF A KIND

Women usually have only one baby at a time, but sometimes twins—or even more babies—are born together. Twins can either be identical (they look the same) or nonidentical. Identical twins occur when a single egg splits into two separate embryos after fertilization. Nonidentical (fraternal) twins happen when two eggs are released at the same time and both are fertilized by different sperm.



◀ TWINS *An ultrasound scan shows twins growing and developing inside their mother's womb at about four months old. Since the babies are still very small, there is plenty of space for them to move around.*

WOW!

You first started to dream while you were still in your mother's womb—around 20 weeks before you were born!

NEW ARRIVAL

After around 40 weeks of pregnancy, a mother gives birth. The muscular wall of the womb contracts to push out the fully grown baby. The umbilical cord, which is no longer needed, is cut and the baby starts to breathe using her lungs.

